



Capstone Part 2

STUDY GUIDE

The **Certified Technical Architect (CTA) exam** is made up of the following nine topic areas, broken down into various sub-topics. Use this document to guide your study as you prepare to take the exam.

1. Configuration Management Database (CMDB) and Common Service Data Model (CSDM):
 - a. Phased approach; CSDM + CMDB process
 - b. CMDB
 - c. CSDM
 - d. Dashboards, health, diagnostics
 - e. Discovery
 - f. Service Mapping
 - g. Identification and Reconciliation Engine (IRE) and Robust Transform Engine (RTE)
2. Technical Governance:
 - a. Decision-making framework
 - b. Governance boards
 - c. Domains of technical governance
3. Testing Leading Practices
 - a. When and why should you test
 - b. Functional testing vs non-functional testing
 - c. Manual testing
 - d. Automated testing
 - e. Automated testing framework (ATF)
 - f. Test management 2.0
 - g. Special test types
4. Go-Live Preparation
 - a. Overview and preparation
 - b. Communication and implementation
 - c. Mitigation, RIAD, hypercare



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5. Security Architecture
 - a. Threat modeling, shared security model, colocation, physical architecture
 - b. IP address access control
 - c. Edge encryption
 - d. Authentication
 - e. Authorization
 - f. Platform encryption (PE), column level encryption (CLE)
 - g. Database encryption, full disk encryption
6. Data Strategies
 - a. Data types, master / core data
 - b. Data import principles
 - c. Data ownership, management
 - d. Data governance, strategy, architecture
 - e. Data security
7. Current and To-Be Architecture
 - a. Architecture blueprints – business capability, service alignment, capability map
 - b. Phased, integration architecture, instance architecture
 - c. Technical architecture domains
 - d. Identifying architecture
8. Platform Data and Integrations
 - a. Introduction and overview
 - b. Leading practices
 - c. Foundation data and governance
 - d. IntegrationHub, spokes, flow designer
 - e. Management, instrumentation, and discovery (MID) servers
 - f. Integration patterns, protocols, web services
 - g. User management
9. Release and Instance Strategy
 - a. Instance strategy governance
 - b. Instance structures and instance management policies
 - c. Environmental strategies, multi-instances
 - d. Release strategy, code migration